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ANNEX 35

RESOLUTION MSC.548(107)
(adopted on 5 June 2023)

INTERNATIONAL CODE OF SAFETY FOR DIVING OPERATIONS, 2023
(2023 DIVING CODE)

THE MARITIME SAFETY COMMITTEE,

RECALLING Article 28(b) of the Convention on the International Maritime Organization concerning the functions of the Committee,

RECALLING ALSO that the Assembly, when adopting, by resolution A.831(19), the Code of Safety for Diving Systems, 1995 (1995 Diving Code), authorized the Committee to amend the Code as necessary in the light of further developments and experience gained from the implementation of the provisions contained therein,

RECALLING FURTHER that the Assembly, by resolution A.692(17), adopted Guidelines and specifications for hyperbaric evacuation systems , noting that hyperbaric evacuation systems

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specifications for hyperbaric evacuation systems , noting that hyperbaric evacuation systems were of value in certain circumstances for the rescue of divers involved in saturation diving operations where support ships might have to be abandoned,
RECALLING that, at its seventy -ninth session, it adopted, by resolution MSC.185(79), amendments to the 1995 Diving Code,
RECOGNIZING the need to ensure that provisions for diving and hyperbaric evacuation operations are kept up to date,
RECOGNIZING ALSO the need to keep the 1995 Diving Code in effect after the adoption of the International Code of Safety for Diving Operations, 2023 (2023 Diving Code), which will apply to ships of not less than 500 gross tonnage that have a diving system installed on or after 1 January 2024,
BEARING IN MIND that the Assembly, by resolution A.886(21), adopted the Procedure for the adoption of, and amendments to, performance standards and technical specifications,
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adoption of, and amendments to, performance standards and technical specifications,
resolving that the function of adopting maritime safety -related performance standards and technical specifications, as well as amendments thereto, shall be performed by the Committee, on behalf of the Organization,
HAVING CONSIDERED, at its 107th session, the recommendation made by the Sub-Committee on Ship Systems and Equipment, at its ninth session,
1 ADOPTS the International Code of Safety for Diving Operations, 2023 (2023 Diving Code), set out in the annex to the present resolution;
2 INVITES Member States concerned to:
.1 consider the provisions of the 2023 Diving Code as recognized international provisions for the design, construction and survey of diving systems, diving units and hyperbaric evacuation systems; and
.2 take appropriate action to give effect to the 2023 Diving Code.
RESOLUTION MSC.548(107) (adopted on 5 June 2023)

.2 take appropriate action to give effect to the 2023 Diving Code.
RESOLUTION MSC.548(107) (adopted on 5 June 2023)
INTERNATIONAL CODE OF SAFETY OR DIVING OPERATIONS, 2023 (2023 DIVING CODE)

ANNEX
INTERNATIONAL CODE OF SAFETY FOR DIVING OPERATIONS, 2023
(2023 DIVING CODE)
PREAMBLE
1 The International Code of Safety for Diving Operations, 2023 (2023 Diving Code) has been developed to provide an international standard of safety for diving units, the application1 of which will result in a level of safety for a diving operation on a diving platform equivalent to that required by the International Convention for the Safety of Life at Sea, 1974 (SOLAS).
2 The intent of the 2023 Diving Code is to enhance the safety of divers and diving support personnel, facilitate the international movement and operation of diving units and
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support personnel, facilitate the international movement and operation of diving units and provide a minimum international standard for the design, construction and survey o f diving units to safely support diving operations.

3 The 2023 Diving Code has been developed for all diving operations from diving units and this includes circumstances where a diving system may be temporarily installed on a diving platform.

4 The 2023 Diving Code expands the scope of the 1995 Code of Safety for Diving Systems (resolution A.831(19), as amended) and the Guidelines and specifications for hyperbaric evacuation systems (resolution A.692(17)), as set out in paragraph 1.4 of appendix 3 to this Code.

5 All diving personnel should be considered as persons on board (POB) with regard to the diving platform 's normal life -saving appliances. However, divers under pressure and requiring lengthy decompression (such as those in saturation) cannot access the diving

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requiring lengthy decompression (such as those in saturation) cannot access the diving platform's normal life-saving appliances. They can only be evacuated in hyperbaric survival craft (HBSC). For the period that such divers are under pressure they do not need to be included in the number of personnel who are allocated to the diving platform's normal life-saving appliances.

6 While the 2023 Diving Code has been developed for new diving units where the diving platform is of 500 gross tonnage and above, Administrations may also consider the application of the provisions of this Code to diving platforms of lesser tonnage and of any age.

7 In order to facilitate the operation of diving units, this Code provides for a "Diving Unit Safety Certificate" (DUSC), which should be issued to every diving unit to which this Code applies. Where a diving unit is normally engaged on international voyages as defined in

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applies. Where a diving unit is normally engaged on international voyages as defined in SOLAS, it shall, in addition, also carry SOLAS safety certificates, either:

.1 for a passenger ship with a SOLAS Exemption Certificate; or

.2 for a cargo ship with a SOLAS Exemption Certificate, where necessary, as the Administration deems appropriate.

8 Taking into account that there are some diving platforms, including fixed offshore installations, to which SOLAS does not apply but which carry out diving operations, Administrations are invited, for the purpose of consideration of the safety of diving operations, to apply the standards of the 2023 Diving Code in such circumstances to the extent deemed reasonable and practicable.

1 This is a non-mandatory code and its application is voluntary.

INTRODUCTION

1 Goal

The goal of the 2023 Diving Code is, especially where diving safety issues are not adequately addressed by other instruments of the Organization,2 to:

.1 provide a minimum international standard for the design, construction, installation and survey of diving systems integrated on ships, floating structures and MODUs (hereafter referred to as diving platforms) engaged in diving operations;

.2 facilitate safe diving operations from diving platforms and achieve a level of safety equivalent to that required by SOLAS for ships engaged on international voyages; and

.3 enable the international movement and safe operation of diving units.

2 Application

2.1 The 2023 Diving Code applies to ships of not less than 500 gross tonnes that have a
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2 Application

2.1 The 2023 Diving Code applies to ships of not less than 500 gross tonnes that have a diving system installed on or after 1 January 2024. The date of the completed installation should be taken as the date on which the DUSC is issued. The Administration may also apply these provisions as far as reasonable and practicable to ships of less than 500 gross tonnes and to other objects acting as a diving unit to which SOLAS does not apply.

2.2 Ships that have a diving system already installed prior to 1 January 2024 should be certified as a diving unit according to this Code by the due date of the next Safety Construction Renewal Survey or equivalent. Diving systems under construction at the time of this Code coming into effect, should consider the installation date as the date the building contract of the diving system was signed.

2.3 The 2023 Diving Code does not apply to the plant and equipment required for the
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diving system was signed.

2.3 The 2023 Diving Code does not apply to the plant and equipment required for the medical care or treatment of patients, not related to diving, in a pressure vessel for human occupancy (PVHO).3

2.4 The coastal State may impose additional or alternative requirements regarding the diving unit and diving operations.

2.5 Where plant and equipment are installed on a standby diving unit, the application of this Code should be considered on a case-by-case basis by the Administration.4

2.6 The instruments referenced in table 1 have been considered in developing the provisions of this Code. In order to meet the goal in 1.2 above, in addition to the provisions of this Code, subsequent amendments to these instruments should also be applied, to the extent that they apply to diving, to the satisfaction of the Administration. The application of new instruments adopted after this Code has come into effect should also be considered.
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instruments adopted after this Code has come into effect should also be considered.

2 For example, by SOLAS; the LSA Code, as amended; the MODU Code, as amended; the FSS Code, as amended; the FTP Code, as amended; the Code of Safety for Diving Systems 1995, as amended; and by the Guidelines and specifications for hyperbaric evacuation systems (resolution A.692(17)).

3 If required by an Administration, appropriate elements of this Code may be applied to a PVHO and associated plant and equipment installed and integrated into a vessel for medical treatment.

4 Guidance on the requirements and certification of standby diving units available in appendix 1 (Guidance on standby diving units).

IMO instrument Reference/Edition 2023 Diving Code
provision

IMO instrument	Reference/Edition	2023 Diving Code provision
International Convention for the Safety of Life at Sea, 1974 (SOLAS)	2020	Preamble 1, 7.1, 7.2, 8
		Goal 1.2
		Application 2.1
		Definition 3.33
		1.2, 1.3, 2.4.3.1, 3.8.3.2, 4.11.3.1, 4.11.3.5, 4.11.3.6
		5.6.3.4
1995 Code of Safety for Diving Systems	Resolution A.831(19), 1995	Preamble 4
		Surveys and certification 5.2.4, 5.3.3 and 5.3.4
Guidelines and specifications for hyperbaric evacuation systems	Resolution A.692(17)	Preamble 4
LSA Code International Life-Saving Appliance Code	Resolution MSC.48(66), amended by MSC.459(101)	Definition 3.25
		4.9.5.2.3
		4.9.5.3.2
		4.15.1. 4.15.2, 4.15.3
FSS Code Code for Fire Safety Systems as defined in SOLAS chapter II-2		Definition 3.18
		4.10.3.3
FTP Code International Code for Application of Fire Test Procedures, 2010	Resolution MSC.307(88)	Definition 3.19
		3.8.3.1
		4.10.3.1

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4.10.3.3
FTP Code International Code for Application
of Fire Test Procedures, 2010
Resolution MSC.307(88)
Definition 3.19
3.8.3.1
4.10.3.1
MODU Code Construction and Equipment of
Mobile Offshore Drilling Units,
Resolution A.1023(26), 2009
Goal 1.1
Definition 3.27
3.7.3.2
Guidelines on anchoring
systems for MODUs
MSC/Circ.737 3.7.3.2
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provision
ISM Code International Safety Management
Code

Resolution A.741(18), as
amended
2.6.3.3
5.1
5.3.1, 5.3.2, 5.3.3.6
5.5.1
5.6.1
IMDG Code International Maritime Dangerous
Goods (IMDG) Code, 2020
3.5.3.5
SPS Code Code of Safety for Special
Purpose Ships, 2008
3.6.3.2
Guidelines for the design
and construction of offshore
supply vessels

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3.5.3.5	SPS Code Code of Safety for Special Purpose Ships, 2008	
3.6.3.2	Guidelines for the design and construction of offshore supply vessels	Resolution MSC.235(82), 2006
3.6.3.1 and 3.6.3.3	Guidelines for vessels with dynamic positioning systems	MSC/Circ.645
3.7.3.1	Guidelines for vessels with dynamic positioning (DP) systems	MSC.1/Circ.1580
3.7.3.1	General requirements for electromagnetic compatibility (EMC) for all electrical and electronic ship's equipment	Resolution A.813(19)
4.11.3.9	Polar Code International Code for Ships Operating in Polar Waters	Resolution MSC.385(94), 2014
5.7.3.6		

Table 1: Referenced IMO instruments

3 Definitions

Unless expressly provided otherwise, for the purpose of this Code, the terms used have the meanings defined in the following paragraphs.

3.1 Administration means the Government of the State whose flag a ship or floating

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meanings defined in the following paragraphs.

3.1 Administration means the Government of the State whose flag a ship or floating structure which carries a diving system is entitled to fly or in which the ship or floating structure is registered.

3.2 Breathing gas/breathing mixture means all gases/mixtures of gases which are used for breathing during diving operations.

3.3 Category A machinery spaces are those spaces and trunks to such spaces as defined in the International Convention for the Safety of Life at Sea, 1974, as amended.

3.4 Certificate means Diving Unit Safety Certificate (DUSC).

3.5 Coastal State means the Government of the State exercising administrative control over the diving operations of the diving unit.

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3.5 Coastal State means the Government of the State exercising administrative control over the diving operations of the diving unit.

3.6 Cylinder means a pressure container for the storage and transport of gases under pressure.

3.7 Daughter-craft means a workboat deployed from and/or operating in conjunction with a diving platform; the workboat is used to deploy divers into and recover them from the water.

3.8 Dive basket (synonymous with diving basket, diving stage or diving cage) means a diver deployment and recovery device normally designed with an open cage structure.

3.9 Diving depth means the depth of water or equivalent pressure to which the diver is exposed at any time during a dive or inside a pressure vessel for human occupancy (PVHO).

3.10 Diving bell (synonymous with closed bell and submersible decompression chamber) means a submersible pressure vessel for human occupancy (PVHO), including its fitted

means a submersible pressure vessel for human occupancy (PVHO), including its fitted equipment, for transfer of diving personnel between the work location and the surface compression chamber.

3.11 Diving operation means a planned activity where one or more persons are exposed to a pressure greater than 100 mbar above atmospheric pressure and which is supported by a pressure vessel for human occupancy (PVHO) and/or a launch and recovery system (LARS).

3.12 Diving organization means the legal entity responsible for conducting a diving operation.

3.13 Diving platform means the ship, floating structure or mobile offshore drilling unit (MODU) from which a diving operation is being conducted.

3.14 Diving system means the whole plant and equipment necessary for the conduct of diving operations and for the evacuation of divers.

3.15 Diving system internal muster point means the location within the surface
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diving operations and for the evacuation of divers.

3.15 Diving system internal muster point means the location within the surface compression chamber complex where the divers gather before entering the hyperbaric survival craft (HBSC) access trunking.

3.16 Diving unit means the combined diving system and diving platform, installed and integrated to conduct diving operations.

3.17 Essential services means the services for maintaining the diving system functionality with regard to the safety, health and environment of the divers in a hyperbaric environment and at the worksite.

3.18 FSS Code means the International Code for Fire Safety Systems, as defined in SOLAS chapter II-2.

3.19 FTP Code means the International Code for Application of Fire Test Procedures, 2010 (2010 FTP Code), as defined in SOLAS chapter II-2.

3.20 Hazardous areas are those locations in which an explosive gas -air mixture is continuously present, or present for long periods (zone 0); in which an explosive gas -air mixture is likely to occur in normal operation (zone 1); in which an explosive gas-air mixture is not likely to occur, and if it does it will only exist for a short time (zone 2).

3.21 Hyperbaric evacuation means the emergency transport of divers under pressure from a diving unit to a place of safety where planned decompression can be completed.

3.22 Hyperbaric survival craft (HBSC) means a pressure vessel for human occupancy (PVHO) and associated support plant and equipment whereby divers under pressure can be
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(PVHO) and associated support plant and equipment whereby divers under pressure can be safely evacuated from a diving unit until recovered to a position where planned decompression can be completed.

3.23 Launch and recovery system (LARS) means the plant and equipment necessary for lowering, raising and transporting divers between the diving platform and/or the surface compression chamber into and from the sea or onto a support vessel, as the case may be. These systems are used for the deployment and recovery of dive baskets, wet bells, diving bells, daughter-craft and HBSC.

3.24 Living compartment means the part of the surface compression chamber which is intended to be used as the main habitation for the divers during diving operations and which is equipped for such purpose.

3.25 LSA Code means the International Life-Saving Appliance Code, as defined in SOLAS chapter III.

3.26 Mating device means the equipment necessary for the connection and disconnection
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3.26 Mating device means the equipment necessary for the connection and disconnection of a diving bell or an HBSC to a surface compression chamber.

3.27 MODU Code means the Code for the Construction and Equipment of Mobile Offshore Drilling Units, adopted by resolution A.1023(26), as amended.

3.28 Organization means the International Maritime Organization (IMO).

3.29 Place of safety means a location where rescue operations are considered to terminate. It is also a place where the survivors' safety of life is no longer threatened and their basic human needs (such as food, shelter and medical/decompression needs) can be met. A place of safety may be on land, or it may be on board a rescue unit or facility at sea that can serve as a place of safety until the survivors are disembarked to their next destination. An assisting ship should not be considered as a place of safety solely on the fact that survivors
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An assisting ship should not be considered as a place of safety solely on the fact that survivors are on board as it may not have appropriate facilities and equipment to sustain the survivors.

3.30 Pressure vessel means a container capable of withstanding an internal maximum working pressure greater than or equal to 1 bar.

3.31 Pressure vessel for human occupancy (PVHO) means a container intended to be occupied by one or more persons that is capable of withstanding an internal or external pressure differential exceeding 0.14 bar (2 psi).

3.32 Saturation diving means a method of diving, using PVHO, that allows divers to remain in the pressurized environment long enough for their body tissues to become saturated with the inert components of the gas mixture they are breathing.5

5 When saturation is reached, long decompression periods are required. As a result, divers cannot safely be brought to the surface quickly, even during an emergency.

3.33 SOLAS means the International Convention for the Safety of Life at Sea, 1974.

3.34 Standby diving unit means a ship carrying plant and equipment solely to assist in the rescue of divers from another diving unit or units.

3.35 Surface compression chamber means a PVHO installed on the diving platform with means of controlling the pressure inside the chamber.

3.36 Surface compression chamber complex means a series of mechanically connected PVHOs including all associated trunkings.

3.37 Surface orientated diving means a method of diving in which it is not planned for the diver(s) to become saturated. The divers may be deployed using a dive basket, wet bell or
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diver(s) to become saturated. The divers may be deployed using a dive basket, wet bell or diving bell or, for shallow dives, directly from the diving platform, depending on what water access is available.

3.38 Temporary diving system means a diving system installed on a diving platform for a period not exceeding one year.

3.39 Umbilical means the link between a PVHO, wet bell or diver and the rest of the diving system and may contain surveillance, communication and power supply cables, breathing gas and hot water hoses. The hoisting and lowering strength member may be part of the umbilical.

3.40 Water depth means the depth of the water in which the diving platform is operating.

3.41 Wet bell means a diver deployment and recovery device as a minimum fitted with a gas filled dome, a main supply umbilical from the surface (providing breathing gas and other service to a manifold inside the device), and diver excursion umbilicals terminated at the device.
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service to a manifold inside the device), and diver excursion umbilicals terminated at the device.

4 Alternative arrangements

In order that research and development is not restricted by the 2023 Diving Code, an Administration may accept alternative arrangements which embody features, or designs, of a novel kind. Any diving unit for which such arrangements have been accepted should provide for an equivalent level of safety which, in the opinion of that Administration, is satisfactory for the operation intended and will ensure the overall safety of the diving unit and diving operation. Any such alternative arrangements accepted by the Administration should be documented on the Certificate.

5 Surveys and certification

5.1 A diving unit represents the integration of a diving system onto or into a diving platform. As the diving system and diving platform may be owned/operated by different parties,
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platform. As the diving system and diving platform may be owned/operated by different parties, a two-part certification process is used with Part I of the Certificate for the diving unit and Part II for the diving system. A model form of the Certificate is presented at appendix 2.

5.2 Every diving unit should be subject to the surveys specified below:

.1 An initial survey before any diving unit is put into service or before the Certificate required under this section of this Code is issued for the first time, which should include a complete and thorough verification of the diving systems integration an d arrangement with the diving platform.
The integration of a diving organization 's occupational health and safety management system, provision of essential services and diving system

limitations listed in Part II of the Certificate are to be verified, as well as the suitability of the life -saving arrangements and the functionality of the whole diving unit.

.2 Where a diving system has already been certified to the provisions of this Code, the status of that certification should be confirmed to be acceptable to the Administration.

.3 Where the DUSC Part II requires an installation survey by the certifying authority of the diving system, this should be completed prior to issuing the DUSC Part I.

.4 Where an existing diving system is not certified in accordance with the Code of Safety for Diving Systems, 1995 (resolution A.831(19)), a DUSC Part II may be issued with validity no longer than 1 January 2029 clearly stating which provisions under 4.3.3 of the Code cannot be confirmed as alternative
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which provisions under 4.3.3 of the Code cannot be confirmed as alternative arrangements for the consideration of the Administration issuing Part I.

.5 A renewal survey at intervals specified by the Administration, but not exceeding five years, which should be a complete and thorough verification to ensure that the diving unit, including the diving system, fully complies with the applicable provisions of this Code.

.6 An annual survey within three months before or after each anniversary date of the Certificate so as to ensure that the diving unit, including the diving system, remains in compliance with the applicable provisions of this Code and are in good working or der. Such annual survey should be endorsed on the Part I of the Certificate issued under the provisions of this section.

5.3 Every diving system forming part of a diving unit should be subject to the surveys specified below:

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5.3 Every diving system forming part of a diving unit should be subject to the surveys specified below:

.1 An initial survey before being put into service as part of a diving unit or before Part II of the Certificate required under this section of this Code is issued for the first time, which should include verification of the diving system, equipment, fittings, arrangements and material and which should be such as to ensure their full compliance with the applicable provisions of this Code.

.2 A renewal survey at intervals specified by the certifying authority, but not exceeding five years, which should be a complete and thorough examination to ensure that the diving system, equipment, fittings, arrangements and material fully comply with the applicable provisions of this Code.

.3 Where an existing diving system has already been certified in accordance with the Code of Safety for Diving Systems, 1995 (resolution A.831(19)), as

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with the Code of Safety for Diving Systems, 1995 (resolution A.831(19)), as amended) then this certification may be accepted as the basis of the DUSC Part II.

.4 Where an existing diving system is not certified in accordance with the Code of Safety for Diving Systems, 1995 (resolution A.831(19)), a DUSC Part II may be issued with validity no longer than 1 January 2029 and clearly stating the circumstances under which the Administration considers it acceptable to issue the DUSC Part II. The DUSC Part II should also state which provisions under 4.3.3 of this Code cannot be confirmed as alternative arrangements for the consideration of the Administration issuing Part I of the DUSC.

.5 An annual survey within three months before or after each anniversary date
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.5 An annual survey within three months before or after each anniversary date of the Certificate so as to ensure that the diving system, fittings, arrangements, safety equipment and other equipment remain in compliance with the applicable provisions of thi s Code and are in good working order. Such annual survey should be endorsed on Part II of the Certificate issued under the provisions of this section.

.6 When a temporary diving system is demobilized, the surveys above may be carried out as far as practicable and endorsed on the Certificate as above. However, upon a remobilization all surveys that were not practicable to carry out while demobilized shoul d be completed and Part II of the Certificate endorsed accordingly.

5.4 An inspection, either general or partial according to the circumstances, should be made every time a defect is discovered or an accident occurs which affects the safety and
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made every time a defect is discovered or an accident occurs which affects the safety and certification of the diving system or whenever a significant repair or alteration is made. The inspection should be such as to ensure that the repairs or alterations carried out have been done effectively and are in all respects in full compliance with the applicable provisions of this Code.

5.5 Surveys and inspections should be carried out by officers of the Administration. The Administration may, however, entrust the surveys either to surveyors nominated for the purpose or to organizations recognized by it. In every case the Administration c oncerned should fully guarantee the completeness and efficiency of the surveys.

5.6 After any survey or inspection under this section has been completed, no significant change should be made in the diving unit without the agreement of the Administration or any

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change should be made in the diving unit without the agreement of the Administration or any person or organization duly authorized by it, except the replacement of equipment and fittings to the equivalent specification for the purpose of repair or maintenance.

5.7 After survey or inspection, a Certificate should be issued either by the Administration or any person or organization duly authorized by it after survey or inspection to a diving unit which complies with the provisions of this Code. In every case the A dministration should assume full responsibility for the Certificate.

5.8 The Certificate should be drawn up in the official language of the Administration in the form corresponding to the model given in appendix 2 to this Code. lf the language used is neither English, French nor Spanish, the text should include a translatio n into one of these languages.

5.9 Any alternative arrangements granted under section 4 above should be clearly noted
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languages.

5.9 Any alternative arrangements granted under section 4 above should be clearly noted on the Certificate.

5.10 A Certificate should be issued for a period specified by the Administration, and should not exceed five years from the date of issue.

5.11 An extension of the validity of the Certificate may be granted for a maximum period of five months at the discretion of the Administration, subject to an annual survey being carried out.

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6 Control

6.1 Every diving system or diving unit, issued with a Certificate under section 5.1 or 5.2 of this Code, is subject, while under the control of an Administration other than that which has
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of this Code, is subject, while under the control of an Administration other than that which has issued the Certificate, to control by officers duly authorized by t hat Administration for verification that the Certificate is valid. Such Certificate should be accepted unless there are clear grounds for believing that the condition of the diving system or diving unit or its equipment does not correspond substantially with the particulars of that Certificate. In that case, the officer carrying out the control may take such steps as will allow the diving unit to operate on a temporary basis without undue risk to the divers and the personnel on board. In the event of this control giving rise to intervention of any kind, the officer carrying out the control should inform the Administration or the Consul or in their absence, the nearest diplomatic representative of the State in which the diving unit is registered, in writing f orthwith of all

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representative of the State in which the diving unit is registered, in writing f orthwith of all circumstances on the basis of which intervention was deemed to be necessary.

6.2 Notwithstanding paragraph 6.1, the provisions of this Code are without prejudice to any rights of the coastal State under international law to impose its own provisions relating to the regulation, surveying and inspection of diving units engaged, or in tending to engage, in diving operations on those parts of the seabed and subsoil over which that State is entitled to exercise sovereign rights.

7 Structure of the Code

This Code contains provisions for the suitability of ships, floating structures and MODUs as platforms for diving systems, the design and testing of diving equipment and plant, and the conduct of diving operations including hyperbaric evacuation. Appendix 1 contains additional guidance on the implementation of these provisions.

1 CHAPTER 1 GENERAL
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guidance on the implementation of these provisions.

1 CHAPTER 1 GENERAL

1.1 Structure of this Code

Each chapter consists of the overall goal of the chapter, functional criteria to fulfil the goal and provisions. A system or operational plan should be considered to meet the functional criteria set out in this Code when the design or arrangements comply with all the provisions associated with those functional criteria.

1.2 Certificate and survey

1.2.1 Every diving unit engaged in diving operations to which this Code applies should have a DUSC Part I. Every diving system used in conjunction with a diving unit should have a DUSC Part II.

1.2.2 The DUSC should be issued after an initial or renewal survey of a diving unit and/or diving system which complies with the relevant provisions of this Code.

1.2.3 The Certificate referred to in this Code should be issued either by the Administration
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1.2.3 The Certificate referred to in this Code should be issued either by the Administration or by any person or organization recognized by it in accordance with SOLAS regulation XI-1/1. In every case, that Administration assumes full responsibility for the certificate.

1.2.4 The DUSC should be drawn up in the form corresponding to the model given in appendix 2 to this Code. If the language used is neither English, French nor Spanish, the text should include a translation into one of these languages.

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1.3 Performance standards

Unless expressly provided otherwise, systems and equipment addressed in this Code should satisfy equivalent performance standards to those referred to in SOLAS.

2 CHAPTER 2 DIVING UNIT PRINCIPLES REDUNDANCY AND INTEGRATION
2.1 Goals

URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.548(107).pdf

2 CHAPTER 2 DIVING UNIT PRINCIPLES REDUNDANCY AND INTEGRATION

2.1 Goals

The goal of this chapter is to define the overall redundancy and integration provisions for the diving unit when integrating the diving system into the diving platform.

2.2 Functional criteria

In order to achieve its goal, this chapter embodies the following provisions.

2.3 Redundancy level and risks external to the diving activity

2.3.1 Goal

The goal of this section is to ensure that the diving unit has sufficient redundancy suitable for its intended operation and for all diving system equipment critical to life support, considering all relevant internal and external risk factors.

2.3.2 Functional criteria

In order to achieve the goal set out in section 2.3.1 above:

.1 the technical level of fault tolerance in the diving unit plant and equipment should be matched to the safety -critical aspects of the intended operation and define any additional levels of redundancy; and

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should be matched to the safety -critical aspects of the intended operation and define any additional levels of redundancy; and

.2 interactions with other objects and non -diving activities both on board and external to the diving unit should not reduce the designed redundancy level.

2.3.3 In order to comply with the functional criteria of section 2.3.2 above, the following apply:

.1 When working on subsea objects where the termination of diving operations may lead to additional risks to the environment or other personnel, the redundancy of the diving unit should be at a level to cover the risks to both the diver and the environment.

.2 When working on subsea objects where the termination of diving operations may be achieved safely without risk at any time, the systematic review required under section 2.4 is considered to achieve an acceptable level.

.3 Where another onboard activity also requires access to systems or services

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.3 Where another onboard activity also requires access to systems or services supporting the diving activity, these should be separated as far as possible. Where these cannot be separated, failures within the other activity 's equipment should be included within a systematic review required under section 2.4.

.4 Where communication, signals or other information are critical to safe diving unit operation, but originate externally to the diving unit or from a non-diving activity, the redundancy of these should be addressed in the systematic review required under section 2.4.

.5 Any findings from the above are to be clearly identified within the systematic review required under section 2.4.

2.4 Redundancy and essential services

2.4.1 Goal

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review required under section 2.4.

2.4 Redundancy and essential services

2.4.1 Goal

The goal of this section is to ensure that the diving unit can tolerate failures without creating a hazardous situation.

2.4.2 Functional criteria

In order to achieve the goal set out in section 2.4.1 above, the diving unit should be designed and tested to ensure and verify that it is sufficiently safeguarded against failures creating a hazardous situation in terms of:

.1 failure of components and systems;

.2 loss of any services to the diving unit; and

.3 inadvertent and intentional acts,

and to ensure that:

.4 the criticality of components and systems is identified;

.5 the designed level of redundancy is maintained throughout the service life; and

.6 mitigations are suitably documented and accessible to the operator.

2.4.3 In order to comply with the functional criteria of section 2.4.2 above, the following apply:

2.4.3 In order to comply with the functional criteria of section 2.4.2 above, the following apply:

.1 All services supporting the divers directly, including environmental control, should be considered as essential services as per SOLAS chapter II-1.

.2 The essential services listed in Part II of the DUSC should be specially considered in relation to the diving platform supply arrangements and all consumer demands.

.3 No single failure of a component, either static or dynamic, nor a single inadvertent act should lead to life-threatening situations for any person, or to unacceptable damage to facilities or the environment. However, w here a failure mode of a system or component cannot be addressed by redundancy, either:

.1 independent backup arrangements should be provided (e.g. in the case of umbilical separation); or